

Goal 2: French and English

A seven-month language roadmap for CELPIP improvement and a serious French foundation

Profile used: English: CELPIP L8/R7/W7/S7 | French: complete beginner | PR objective | Night shift

Outcome to pursue: make English CLB 8-9 the realistic seven-month target, treat CLB 10 as a stretch, and build French from zero toward A2/early B1 with a longer-term route to NCLC 7-8.

Your 29 May 2025 CELPIP result should generally remain valid until 29 May 2027 because IRCC requires language results to be less than two years old when you create a profile and submit your PR application. Retesting in early 2027 gives you a fresh result.

1. Feasibility and test targets

Goal	Seven-month assessment	Longer-term target
English CLB 10	Aggressive stretch from L8/R7/W7/S7	Possible with targeted practice and retesting
French NCLC 7	Stretch from complete beginner; do not assume it	Approximately 12-24+ months for a serious attempt
French NCLC 8	Unlikely in seven months from zero	Pursue after NCLC 7 foundation and sustained practice

French NCLC 7 in all four abilities is required for the Express Entry French-language category. French can add up to 50 CRS points when English is at least CLB 5 in all four abilities, but French alone does not guarantee an invitation.

2. Weekly study budget

Period	French	English	Method
Months 1-2	8 hours	4 hours	Short daily sessions; one longer Friday/Saturday block
Months 3-4	9-10 hours	5 hours	Add timed tasks and weekly speaking feedback
Months 5-7	10-12 hours	5-6 hours	Test preparation; reduce on peak-shift weeks

The base plan is 12-18 language hours per week. During peak season, protect sleep and complete the minimum viable routine instead of studying through severe fatigue.

3. French month-by-month progression

Month	Target	Required work
1	Pronunciation and A1	Sounds, alphabet, greetings, numbers, gender, present tense, 300-500 words
2	Functional A1	Questions, negation, common verbs, self-introduction, basic listening
3	A2 foundation	Past and near future, routines, descriptions, 800-1,200 words
4	A2+	Longer listening, simple opinions, short paragraphs, weekly conversation
5	Early B1	Connectors, explanations, roleplays, 1,500-2,000 words
6	B1 test preparation	Timed reading/listening, structured speaking and writing, full diagnostic
7	Test decision	Take an official test only if two mocks justify the cost; otherwise continue

French skill practice

- Listening: daily short audio, dictation twice weekly, then varied accents and timed multiple-choice practice.
- Speaking: shadow a model sentence, record a one-minute answer, and add a weekly roleplay from month 3.
- Reading: graded text first, then timed articles, connectors, inference, and scanning for details.
- Writing: begin with messages and descriptions, then structured opinion paragraphs and correction logs.
- Vocabulary and grammar: Anki or another spaced-repetition system; learn phrases and examples, not isolated translations only.

4. English/CELPPIP plan

Month	English target	Practice
1	Diagnose every skill	Official sample test; grammar, pronunciation, sentence structure
2	Reliable CLB 8 tasks	Two listening/reading sets; one corrected writing task weekly
3	Timed performance	Two speaking recordings and one email/survey response weekly
4	Full mock	Identify the lowest ability and use a four-week repair plan
5	First official attempt	Book January 2027 only if mocks are consistently strong
6	Remediation	Two full mocks; focus on the weakest section
7	Retake buffer	Retake around March 2027 if needed; keep results fresh

CELPPIP skill routines

- Listening: predict the answer, note names/numbers/opinions, and practise once-through audio without pausing.
- Reading: skim purpose and structure, mark evidence, and maintain a workplace vocabulary list.
- Writing: write one email and one survey response weekly; use purpose, details, requested action, and closing.
- Speaking: record two prompts weekly using position, reason, example, and conclusion; explain technical problems to a nontechnical customer.

5. TEF Canada or TCF Canada

Both tests are accepted by IRCC. Neither automatically gives a PR advantage. Choose by test-centre availability, total price, computer or paper preference, and which official practice format produces the better score. Commit to one by month 2 or 3.

Level	TEF speaking	TEF listening	TEF reading	TEF writing	TCF speaking	TCF listening	TCF reading	TCF writing
NCLC 7	310-348	249-279	207-232	310-348	10-11	458-502	453-498	10-11
NCLC 8	349-370	280-297	233-247	349-370	12-13	503-522	499-523	12-13

For TEF, use the score column and equivalency instructions specified by IRCC. Do not enter an incompatible raw-score column in an Express Entry profile.

6. Low-cost resources

Area	Start with	Optional paid support
French foundation	TV5MONDE Premiere classe, RFI Francais facile, Mauril, Anki, structured beginner videos	Used grammar books; one tutor session weekly from month 3
English	CELPPIP official samples, library, CBC audio, Write & Improve, recorded answers	One speaking/writing review session before each official test
Conversation	Alliance Francaise groups, community events, language exchanges	iTalki or Preply 30-minute session
Mock exams	Official CELPIP and TEF/TCF sample tests	Do not pay for an exam until practice performance is stable

7. Tracking system

Use one spreadsheet with date, minutes, skill, resource, new vocabulary, error, corrected version, review date, mock score, and next action.

Weekly minimum	Target
French	8-12 hours, one speaking session, one writing task, vocabulary review six days
English	4-6 hours, two speaking recordings, one corrected writing task, one timed set
Monthly	One diagnostic; retain a list of the three highest-impact errors

8. Minimum viable language day

- French Anki or review for 10 minutes.
- Listen to French for 10 minutes while following a transcript.
- Answer one English speaking prompt or edit three sentences.
- Write down one error and its corrected form.

Sources and verification links

IRCC, Express Entry language tests and conversions |

<https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/language-test.html>

IRCC, French-language proficiency category |

<https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/rounds-invitations/category-based-selection.html>

IRCC, CRS criteria and French bonus |

<https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/check-score/crs-criteria.html>